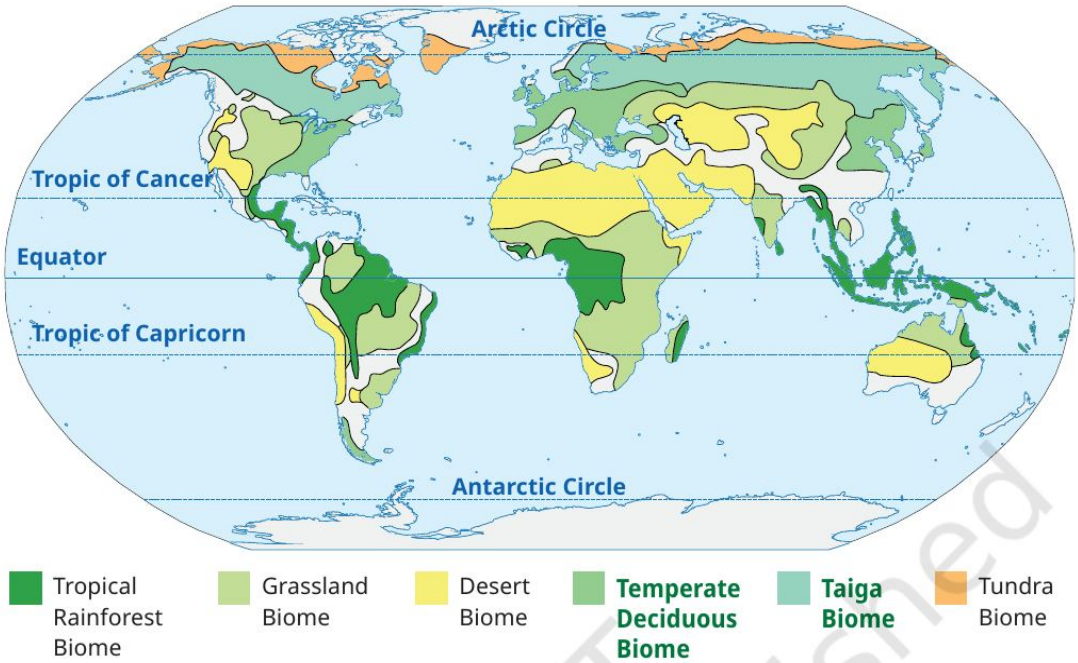


Fig. 2.2. World map showing distribution of biomes (map not to scale)

Temperate deciduous biome: This biome is characterised by forests of broad-leaved trees that shed their leaves seasonally, with moderate temperatures and distinct seasons.

Taiga biome: This biome is characterised by coniferous forests consisting mainly of pines, spruces, and larches.

LET'S MAP

Look at the world map in Fig. 2.2 and answer the following questions.

→ Which type of biome is found in smaller, separate regions, and why?

→ Which continent has the least number of biomes? What could be the reason for this?

→ Why are there areas that do not have any specific biomes?

Types of Biomes

Now that you have understood the meaning and uniqueness of biomes, let us identify the different types of biomes. Different **biomes** support diverse plant and animal life and can be categorised into **terrestrial** (land-based) and **aquatic biomes** (water-based).

There are several factors that determine which types of plants and animals can survive and thrive in a biome. These include temperature, precipitation patterns, dominant plant species, growth forms of vegetation, etc.

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